



MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

EDITION 2026.1

WHY HAS PEACE PROVED SO ELUSIVE IN THE MIDDLE EAST?

*Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945-1995 -
Key Topic 1: The birth of the state of Israel, 1945-*

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Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER

TARGET GRADE: _____

Grade		9-1 GCSE Grading Scale		
Lesson / Assessment Title		Effort	Level	Teacher Comments
L1: KT1: Geography of the Middle East				
L2: KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949				
L3: KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War				
L4: KT1.3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: KT1: Geography of the Middle East

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand how the collapse of the Ottoman Empire after WW1 and the secret Sykes-Picot Agreement (1916) created artificial borders and European mandates in the Middle East.
- ☐ Examine conflicting British wartime promises: the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence (1915) versus the Balfour Declaration (1917).
- ☐ Define and contrast the core historical ideologies of Zionism and Arab Nationalism.
- ☐ Identify the strategic geography of the region, including vital maritime chokepoints (Suez Canal, Straits of Tiran) and contested territories (West Bank, Gaza Strip, Golan Heights, Sinai Peninsula).

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What does 'empire' mean?

What does 'colony' mean?

In what year did the First World War end?

What does 'mandate' mean in an international context?

What was the League of Nations?

What does 'assassination' mean?

What is a 'dictatorship'?

What is a 'republic'?

What does 'nationalism' mean?

What is 'propaganda'?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *FOUR* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Sykes-Picot Agreement Mandate Balfour Declaration Zionism Arab Nationalism Chokepoint Contested Territory
--

Q1. Explain why the Sykes-Picot Agreement and League of Nations mandates created artificial borders in the Middle East.

Q2. Explain the fundamental contradiction between the McMahon-Hussein Correspondence and the Balfour Declaration.

Q3. Why were the Golan Heights and the Straits of Tiran of supreme strategic importance in the Arab-Israeli wars?

Map Task: The Geopolitical Landscape

Understanding the geography of the Middle East is the essential first step to understanding its history. The borders of the modern Middle East were largely drawn by Britain and France following the collapse of the Ottoman Empire at the end of the First World War. These

artificially imposed borders laid the groundwork for decades of instability.

At the heart of the conflict are several highly contested regions: the Gaza Strip, the West Bank, the Golan Heights, and the Sinai Peninsula. Additionally, control over strategic waterways—like the Suez Canal, the Straits of Tiran, and the River Jordan—has repeatedly triggered military escalation.

Pair & Share Activity

Q4. Prompt: Discuss with your partner: Why is the geography of the Middle East so geopolitically important?

Think: Spend 1 minute quietly considering the question and forming your own opinion.

Your Notes:

Map Task: The Geopolitical Landscape

Source A

Reference Map



Scaffolding & Hints:

- Look carefully at the coastal outlines to locate the Mediterranean and Red Seas.
- Remember that the Sinai Peninsula connects Africa to Asia.

Q5. Using the blank map provided in your workbook (or the interactive map here), label the following: - Countries: Israel, Egypt, Syria, Jordan, Lebanon, Iraq, Iran - Capitals: Jerusalem, Tel Aviv, Cairo, Damascus, Amman, Beirut - Waterways: Suez Canal, Straits of Tiran, Gulf of Aqaba, Red Sea, River Jordan, Mediterranean Sea - Contested Zones (shade these): Sinai Peninsula, Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank



Pupil Voice

What was the most significant event or decision in today's lesson, and what was its major historical consequence?

General Notes

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

L2: KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand the conflicting interests and demands of Jews and Arabs within the British Mandate.
- ☐ Analyze the key events leading to the end of the British Mandate, partition and the creation of Israel, including the significance of the bombing of the King David Hotel and UN Resolution 181.
- ☐ Describe the key events of the Arab-Israeli war (1948–49).

Q1. What impact did the King David Hotel bombing have on the British Mandate?

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What does 'empire' mean?

What does 'colony' mean?

In what year did the First World War end?

What does 'mandate' mean in an international context?

What was the League of Nations?

What does 'assassination' mean?

What is a 'dictatorship'?

What is a 'republic'?

What does 'nationalism' mean?

What is 'propaganda'?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Mandate Zionism Irgun Nakba
--

Your Sentence:

Q2. What was the 'dual obligation' that Britain faced under the League of Nations Mandate of Palestine?

Q3. Identify two reasons why Foreign Secretary Ernest Bevin set a strict immigration quota of 1,500 Jewish immigrants per month.

Q4. What was the 'Jewish Insurgency' and which three Zionist groups united to launch it?

Q5. Describe the deadliest act of the insurgency on 22 July 1946 and explain its intended target.

Q6. How did the British public react to the 'Sergeants Affair', and what was the political result?

Q7. How did the United Nations Partition Plan (Resolution 181) divide the land of Palestine, and what was the reaction of the two communities?

Q8. What was the impact of the Deir Yassin massacre on the Palestinian Arab population in April 1948?

Q9. Describe the tactical advantage Israel gained during the first UN truce in June 1948.

Q10. Explain the conflicting historical views regarding the displacement of over 700,000 Palestinians during the 1948 war.

Pair & Share Activity

Q11. Prompt: If you were the British government in 1945, exhausted by WWII and facing attacks from Jewish paramilitaries, what would you have done with the Mandate?

Your Notes:

Historian's Corner: The Debate over Plan Dalet

Historians sharply disagree on the nature of Plan D. Traditional Israeli historians argue it was a purely defensive necessity to secure besieged Jewish settlements before the Arab armies invaded. However, 'New Historians' like Ilan Pappé argue the text of Plan D proves it was a deliberate blueprint for the systematic ethnic cleansing of Palestinian Arabs from the future Jewish state.

Q12. How does Pappé's interpretation of Plan Dalet fundamentally change our understanding of the Palestinian refugee crisis?

GCSE Exam Practice

Q13. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1945–48 which led to the creation of Israel. [8 marks • 10 mins]

[8 marks • 10 mins]

Planning your narrative account:

Remember to link your paragraphs chronologically. You could use these sentence starters:

- *The first key event was...*
- *This directly led to...*
- *Consequently, this triggered...*
- *This situation culminated in...*

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Q14. Explain the importance of conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews for the British Mandate. 1945-48.

Q15. Explain the importance of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946) for the ending of the British Mandate in 1947.

Q16. Explain one consequence of growing Jewish insurgency during the British Mandate 1946-1947.

Q17. Write a narrative account analysing the conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews in the British Mandate 1945-47.

Q18. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1946-48 that led to the creation of Israel.

Q19. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war from 1948 to 1949.



Pupil Voice

What was the most important change that occurred during this period, and what remained continuous (the same)?

General Notes

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L3: KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the territorial changes and their impact, including the refugee status of Palestinian Arabs.
- ☐ Understand the creation of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) and the Law of Return (1950), and the importance of US aid to Israel.
- ☐ Analyze Israel's relations with Egypt in the aftermath of the war.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

Why did Britain refer the Palestine issue to the UN in 1947?

What did the UN Special Committee on Palestine (UNSCOP) recommend?

How did the Arab Higher Committee respond to the UN Partition Plan?

What was the significance of the attack on Deir Yassin in April 1948?

When did David Ben-Gurion officially declare the creation of the State of Israel?

What does 'empire' mean?

What does 'mandate' mean?

What was the League of Nations?

In what year did WW1 end?

What does 'nationalism' mean?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Green Line**

Q1. What happened to the remaining portions of mandate Palestine (the West Bank and Gaza Strip) following the 1948-49 war?

Q2. How did the United Nations attempt to cope with the vast humanitarian emergency created by the displacement of 700,000 Palestinian Arabs?

Q3. Why did both Israel and the Arab host states refuse to permanently integrate the Palestinian refugees into their societies?

Q4. Why was the establishment of the Israeli Defence Forces (IDF) in May 1948 highly significant for Israel's internal politics and national security?

Q5. Explain the demographic impact of the 1950 Law of Return on the new State of Israel.

Q6. Why did President authorise massive emergency loans and grants to Israel in its early years?

Q7. Describe two ways that Egypt attempted to strangle Israel economically and militarily in the early 1950s.

Q8. How did David Ben-Gurion attempt to deter Fedayeen border raids, and what was the consequence?

Q9. Explain one consequence of the territorial changes following the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli war.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Pair & Share Activity

Q10. Prompt: Why do you think the well-equipped Arab armies were defeated by the newly formed Israeli Defense Forces?

Your Notes:

[4 marks • 5 mins]

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Q12. Explain one consequence of the 1948-49 Arab-Israeli War.

Q13. Explain the importance of the Arab-Israeli conflict of 1948 for relations between Palestinians and Israelis.

Q14. Explain one consequence of Israel passing the Law of Return (1950).

Q15. Write a narrative account analysing the growth of Israel 1949-1954.

Q16. Explain the importance of US aid to Israel for the consolidation of the new state in the years 1949-54.

Q17. Explain the importance of Israel's early relations with Egypt for the stability of the region in the years 1949–54.



Pupil Voice

How did the events or developments studied today affect different groups of people in contrasting ways?

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L4: KT1.3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Understand Nasser and Egypt's leadership of the Arab world.
- ☐ Analyze the events and significance of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955 and Sinai in 1956.
- ☐ Evaluate the events and significance of the Suez Crisis (1956), including the formation of the United Arab Republic (UAR) in 1958.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 10

What was the 1948-49 Arab-Israeli War?

Which Arab nations invaded Israel in 1948?

Why did the Israelis ultimately win the 1948-49 war?

What was the impact of the war on Israel's borders?

What was the Nakba?

When did David Ben-Gurion declare the State of Israel?

What did UNSCOP recommend in 1947?

Why did Britain refer the issue to the UN?

What was the attack on Deir Yassin?

What does 'colony' mean?

Vocabulary Check

Fill in the blanks using the vocabulary words below.

Pan-Arabism | Czech Arms Deal | Nationalisation | Protocol of Sèvres | UNEF

Driven by the ideology of [.], sought to modernize Egypt. Following the [.], the West refused to fund his dam project. In retaliation, Nasser announced the [.] of the Suez Canal. This led to the secret [.] where Israel, Britain, and France invaded Egypt. The conflict ended with the deployment of [.] peacekeepers in the Sinai.

Q1. What were Gamal Abdel Nasser's immediate political and domestic objectives after taking power in Egypt?

Q2. Why did Israel launch a devastating reprisal raid on the Gaza Strip on 28 February 1955, and what was the result?

Q3. What was the significance of the 1955 Czech Arms Deal for the balance of power in the Middle East?

Q4. How did President Nasser respond when the United States and Great Britain abruptly withdrew their funding for the Aswan High Dam?

Q5. What was the secret Protocol of Sèvres in October 1956?

Q6. Explain how Britain and France planned to use an Israeli invasion of the Sinai as a pretext to retake the Suez Canal.

Q7. Why did the Anglo-French-Israeli conspiracy backfire and end in a humiliating retreat?

Q8. Identify two vital security guarantees Israel received in exchange for withdrawing its forces from the Sinai Peninsula.

Q9. Explain one consequence of the nationalisation of the Suez Canal in 1956.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Pair & Share Activity

Q10. Prompt: Why was the Suez Canal so important to Britain and France that they were willing to go to war over it?

Your Notes:

GCSE Exam Practice

Q11. Explain one consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956) for the Middle East.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

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Q12. Explain the importance of Israeli attacks on Gaza, 1955, for relations between Egypt and Israel.

Q13. Explain one consequence of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955.

Q14. Explain one consequence of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956).

Q15. Explain one consequence of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958.

Q16. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956).

Q17. Explain the importance of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958 for regional tension in the Middle East.

Q18. Explain the importance of Nasser for tension in the Middle East in the years 1955-63.

 Pupil Voice

What piece of historical evidence (e.g. government record, personal diary, photograph) would be most valuable to investigate today's enquiry, and why?

General Notes

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End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East (1945–1995)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)

GCSE Exam Practice: Question Bank

Choose an exam question from the bank below and answer it on the blank lined pages that follow.

From KT1: Geography of the Middle East

Q. Using the blank map provided in your workbook (or the interactive map here), label the following: - Countries: Israel, Egypt, Syria, Jordan, Lebanon, Iraq, Iran - Capitals: Jerusalem, Tel Aviv, Cairo, Damascus, Amman, Beirut - Waterways: Suez Canal, Straits of Tiran, Gulf of Aqaba, Red Sea, River Jordan, Mediterranean Sea - Contested Zones (shade these): Sinai Peninsula, Golan Heights, Gaza Strip, West Bank

From KT1.1: The End of the British Mandate and the Creation of Israel, 1945–1949

Q.. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1945–48 which led to the creation of Israel.

- 1. Explain the importance of conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews for the British Mandate. 1945–48.**
- 2. Explain the importance of the bombing of the King David Hotel (1946) for the ending of the British Mandate in 1947.**
- 3. Write a narrative account analysing the conflicting interests and demands of Arabs and Jews in the British Mandate 1945–47.**
- 4. Explain one consequence of growing Jewish insurgency during the British Mandate 1946–1947.**
- 5. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of 1946–48 that led to the creation of Israel.**
- 6. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Arab-Israeli war from 1948 to 1949.**

From KT1.2: The Aftermath of the 1948–49 War

Q.. Explain one consequence of the territorial changes following the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli war.

- 1. Explain one consequence of the 1948–49 Arab-Israeli War.**
- 2. Explain the importance of the Arab-Israeli conflict of 1948 for relations between Palestinians and Israelis.**
- 3. Write a narrative account analysing the growth of Israel 1949–1954.**
- 4. Explain the importance of US aid to Israel for the consolidation of the new state in the years 1949–54.**
- 5. Explain the importance of Israel's early relations with Egypt for the stability of the region in the years 1949–54.**
- 6. Explain one consequence of Israel passing the Law of Return (1950).**

From KT1.3: Increased Tension, 1955–1963

Q.. Explain one consequence of the Suez Crisis (1956) for the Middle East.

- 1. Explain the importance of Israeli attacks on Gaza, 1955, for relations between Egypt and Israel.**
- 2. Explain one consequence of Israeli attacks on Gaza in 1955.**
- 3. Explain one consequence of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956).**
- 4. Write a narrative account analysing the key events of the Suez Canal Crisis (1956).**
- 5. Explain one consequence of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958.**
- 6. Explain the importance of the formation of the United Arab Republic, UAR, in 1958 for regional tension in the Middle East.**
- 7. Explain the importance of Nasser for tension in the Middle East in the years 1955–63.**

[illegible]

[illegible]

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